



MWOS FOOTBALL CLUB

SCOUTING DEPARTMENT – SCOUTS CODE OF CONDUCT

Purpose

The purpose of this Code of Conduct is to establish the professional, ethical, and operational standards expected from all scouts and scouting representatives working with or on behalf of MWOS Football Club.

All MWOS FC scouts are expected to conduct themselves with integrity, professionalism, loyalty, and respect for the game at all times while protecting the interests, reputation, and confidential information of the club.

1. Role and responsibilities of a scout

1.1 The primary role of a scout is to identify and recommend players who may be suitable for recruitment, development, trial opportunities, or future registration with MWOS FC.

1.2 Scouts are not authorized to independently negotiate, promise contracts, guarantee trials, or offer any inducements to players, parents, coaches, or club officials without the approval of MWOS FC management.

1.3 Scouts represent MWOS FC at all times and are therefore expected to act in a professional and ethical manner that reflects positively on the club and the game of football.

2. Professional conduct

MWOS FC scouts must:

- Conduct themselves with honesty, integrity, professionalism, and fairness at all times;
- Promote and protect the image, reputation, and interests of MWOS FC;
- Respect all football governing body regulations and club policies;
- Maintain loyalty toward MWOS FC and avoid any conduct that may bring the club or the game into disrepute;
- Behave respectfully toward players, parents, coaches, referees, club officials, and members of the football community;
- Always act in the best interests of player development and safeguarding.

3. Recruitment and safeguarding requirements

All scouts must:

- Successfully complete the MWOS FC recruitment and induction process;
- Provide a valid Police Clearance Certificate and acceptable references;
- Attend and complete the following MWOS FC workshops and training programmes:
 - Safeguarding Children and Young People in Football
 - Introduction to Scouting
 - MWOS Scouting Hub Training
- Maintain an understanding of football regulations, youth development structures, and safeguarding procedures;
- Demonstrate appropriate knowledge of player technical, tactical, physical, psychological, and social development.

4. Match attendance and identification

4.1 When attending matches or football events in an official capacity, scouts must wear the official MWOS Scout jersey provided by the club and carry valid MWOS FC identification, which must be presented upon request.

4.2 Scouts are expected to:

- Introduce themselves professionally to club officials, coaches, or match organizers before observing matches;
- Clearly identify themselves as representatives of MWOS FC;
- Respect the environment and culture of grassroots and youth football.

4.3 Official MWOS FC identification badges:

- Must contain a photograph and current season details;
- Shall be renewed at the beginning of each season;
- Must be returned immediately upon termination of involvement with the club.

5. Communication with players and parents

Scouts must:

- Always communicate honestly and professionally with players and parents;
- Be realistic when discussing player potential and development opportunities;
- Respect safeguarding and child protection principles at all times.

Scouts must not:

- Make unrealistic promises;
- Guarantee contracts, scholarships, or trials without club approval;
- Abuse their position or authority;
- Request money, gifts, favours, or any personal benefits from players, parents, clubs, or other officials.

6. Confidentiality, data protection and club loyalty

6.1 Scouts must maintain strict confidentiality regarding:

- Internal club information;
- Scouting reports;
- Player databases;
- Recruitment strategies;
- Technical documents;
- All MWOS FC operational matters.

6.2 Scouts shall never:

- Share confidential information with unauthorized individuals;
- Disclose internal scouting material to third parties;
- Provide access to their MWOS FC Scouting Hub account to any other person.

6.3 All MWOS FC Scouting Hub accounts remain the property of the club and must be deactivated immediately when a scout is no longer associated with MWOS FC.

6.4 Scouts are expected to demonstrate loyalty and professionalism at all times and avoid any conduct that could damage the reputation or interests of MWOS FC.

7. Conflict of interest

7.1 Scouts must immediately disclose to MWOS FC any direct or indirect interest in transactions, relationships, or arrangements that may create a conflict of interest involving the club.

7.2 Scouts shall not personally profit from recruitment activities conducted on behalf of MWOS FC unless specifically authorized in writing by the club.

8. Club participation and reporting

Scouts are expected to:

- Maintain regular communication with the club;
- Submit scouting reports and required documentation on time;
- Attend meetings, workshops, and training sessions organized by MWOS FC when requested;
- Cooperate fully with club supervision and operational procedures.

9. Disciplinary measures and consequences of breach

Failure to comply with this Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action, including but not limited to:

- Verbal or written warnings;
- Meetings with MWOS FC officials;
- Suspension from scouting duties;
- Removal of Scouting Hub access;
- Termination of contract or membership.

Any scout found to have:

- Shared confidential club information;
- Provided unauthorized third-party access to the MWOS FC Scouting Hub;
- Or seriously damaged the reputation or interests of the club

may face immediate termination of their involvement with MWOS FC and may also be subject to financial penalties or further legal action where applicable.

10. MWOS FC responsibilities and Scout benefits

Scouts recruited by MWOS FC on a voluntary basis may be provided with:

- Official MWOS FC Scout jersey and identification badge;

- Access to the MWOS FC Scouting Hub platform;
- Home match tickets at Ngoni Stadium for Premier League, Division One and Division Two fixtures (subject to prior request at least two weeks in advance);
- Educational courses, seminars, and scouting workshops;
- Reimbursement of reasonable travel expenses related to official meetings and educational activities;
- The opportunity to work alongside experienced football professionals in scouting, recruitment, and player development.

11. Final statement

MWOS Football Club is committed to creating a professional, ethical, safe, and development-focused scouting environment that protects young players, supports football development, and upholds the values and reputation of both the club and the game.

All scouts associated with MWOS FC are expected to fully understand, respect, and comply with this Code of Conduct at all times.